

STEP-BY-STEP GUIDE

Hosting Your Website on GitHub

Publish a real website for free with GitHub Pages — from sign-up to a live page at

`yourusername.github.io`

Adapted from *Khan Academy* — “Hosting your website on Github” (Intro to HTML/CSS: Making webpages)

What is GitHub Pages?

1

Code repositories

GitHub hosts “repositories” — collections of a project's code. Many are open source, so the whole world can read and learn from them.

2

GitHub Pages

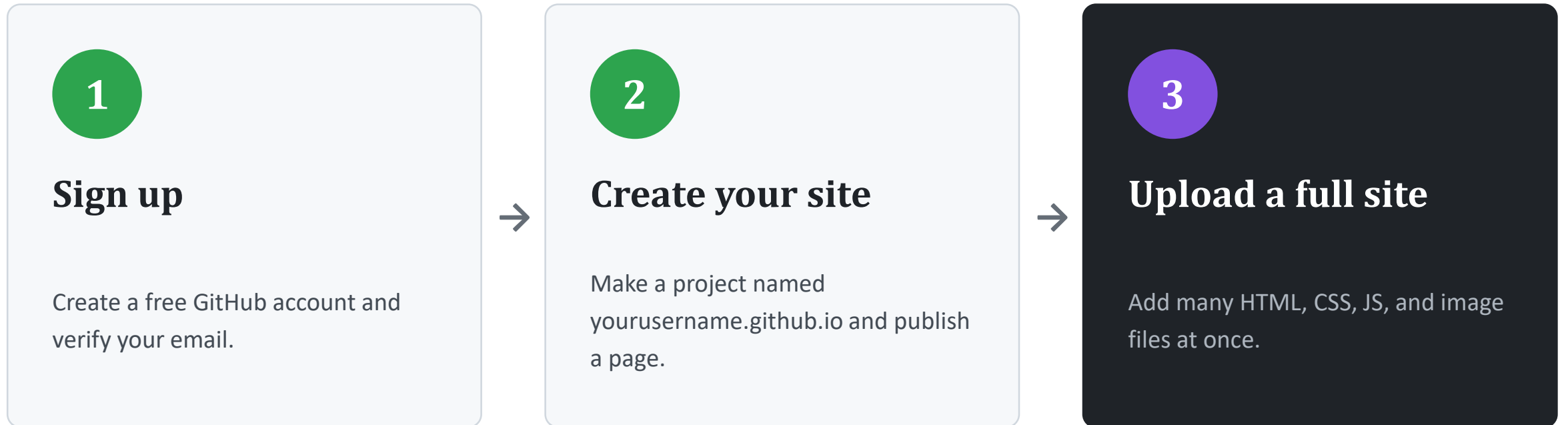
A free feature that turns a repository into a live, multi-file website hosted at `yourusername.github.io`.

3

Before you start

Khan Academy is not affiliated with GitHub. Review GitHub's Terms of Use first, especially if you are under 13.

The plan — three parts



PART 1

Sign up for a GitHub account

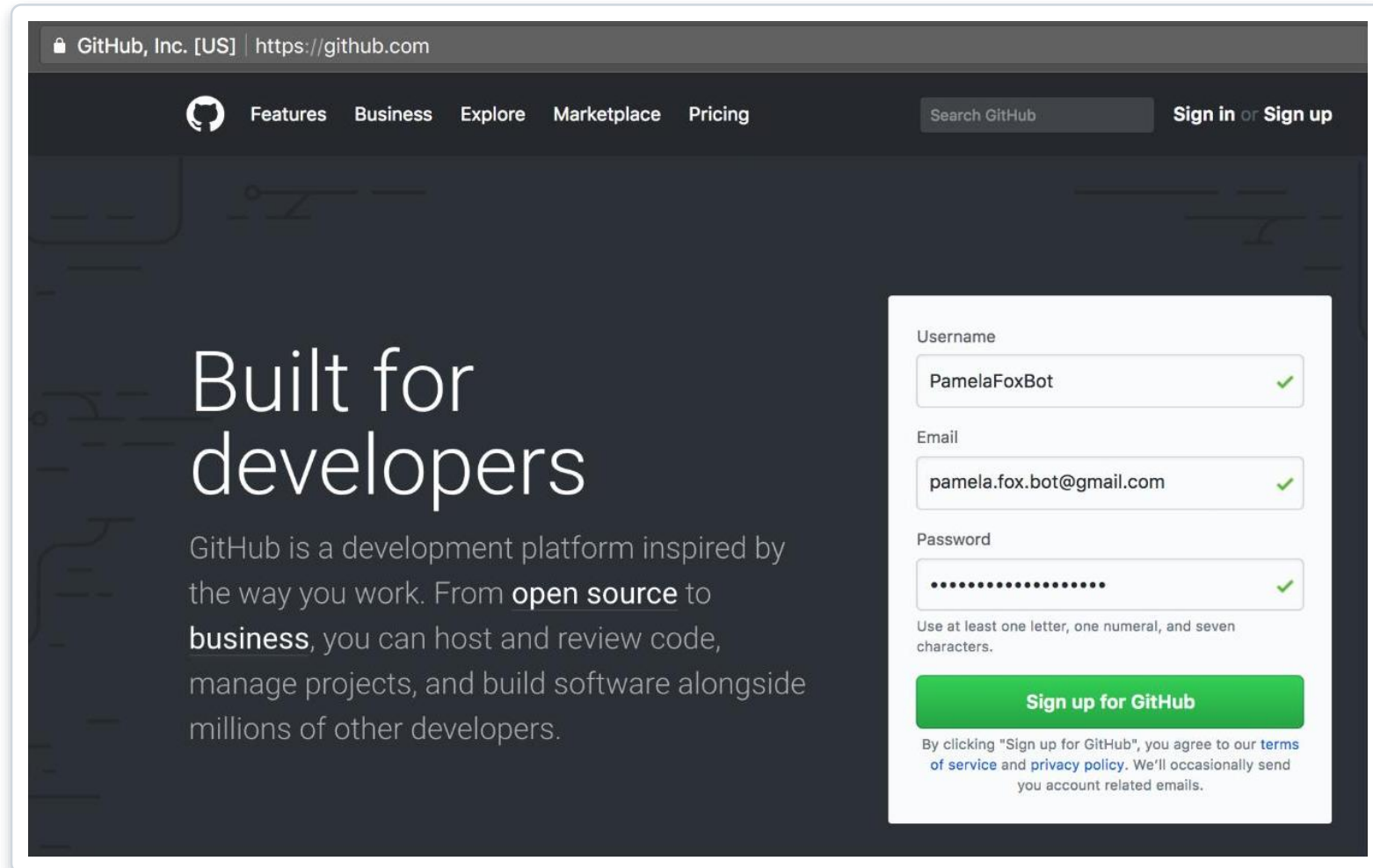
Create your free account and verify your email — the username you pick becomes part of your website address.

1

PART 1 · STEP 1

Sign up for an account

Visit github.com and fill in the signup form on the front page. *Your username is public and appears in your URL: `yourusername.github.io`.*

A screenshot of the GitHub website's sign-up page. The browser's address bar shows 'GitHub, Inc. [US] | https://github.com'. The navigation bar includes links for 'Features', 'Business', 'Explore', 'Marketplace', and 'Pricing', along with a search bar and 'Sign in or Sign up' links. The main content area has a dark background with the text 'Built for developers' and a description of GitHub as a development platform. On the right, a white sign-up form is displayed with fields for 'Username' (PamelaFoxBot), 'Email' (pamela.fox.bot@gmail.com), and 'Password' (masked with dots). Each field has a green checkmark indicating it is valid. Below the password field is a note: 'Use at least one letter, one numeral, and seven characters.' A green 'Sign up for GitHub' button is at the bottom of the form, followed by a disclaimer about agreeing to terms of service and privacy policy.

2

PART 1 · STEP 2

Choose the free plan

On Step 2, pick the free plan. *A public website repository needs nothing more — you can upgrade later.*

Welcome to GitHub

You've taken your first step into a larger world, @PamelaFoxBot.

✓ Completed
Set up a personal account

 Step 2:
Choose your plan

 Step 3:
Tailor your experience

Choose your personal plan

☒ Unlimited public repositories for free.

☐ Unlimited private repositories for \$7/month.

Don't worry, you can cancel or upgrade at any time.

☐ **Help me set up an organization next**
Organizations are separate from personal accounts and are best suited for businesses who need to manage permissions for many employees.
[Learn more about organizations](#)

☐ **Send me updates on GitHub news, offers, and events**
Unsubscribe anytime in your email preferences. [Learn more](#)

Continue

Both plans include:

- ✓ Collaborative code review
- ✓ Issue tracking
- ✓ Open source community
- ✓ Unlimited public repositories
- ✓ Join any organization

3

PART 1 · STEP 3

Answer or skip the survey

On Step 3, you can answer the survey questions or simply skip this step.

Welcome to GitHub

You'll find endless opportunities to learn, code, and create,
@PamelaFoxBot.

✓ Completed
Set up a personal account

📄 Step 2:
Choose your plan

⚙️ Step 3:
Tailor your experience

How would you describe your level of programming experience?

☐ Totally new to programming ☒ Somewhat experienced ☐ Very experienced

What do you plan to use GitHub for? (check all that apply)

☐ Design ☐ Development ☐ Project Management
☒ School projects ☐ Research ☐ Other (please specify)

Which is closest to how you would describe yourself?

☒ I'm a student ☐ I'm a professional ☐ I'm a hobbyist
☐ Other (please specify)

What are you interested in?

web-development ✕

e.g. tutorials, android, ruby, web-development, machine-learning, open-source

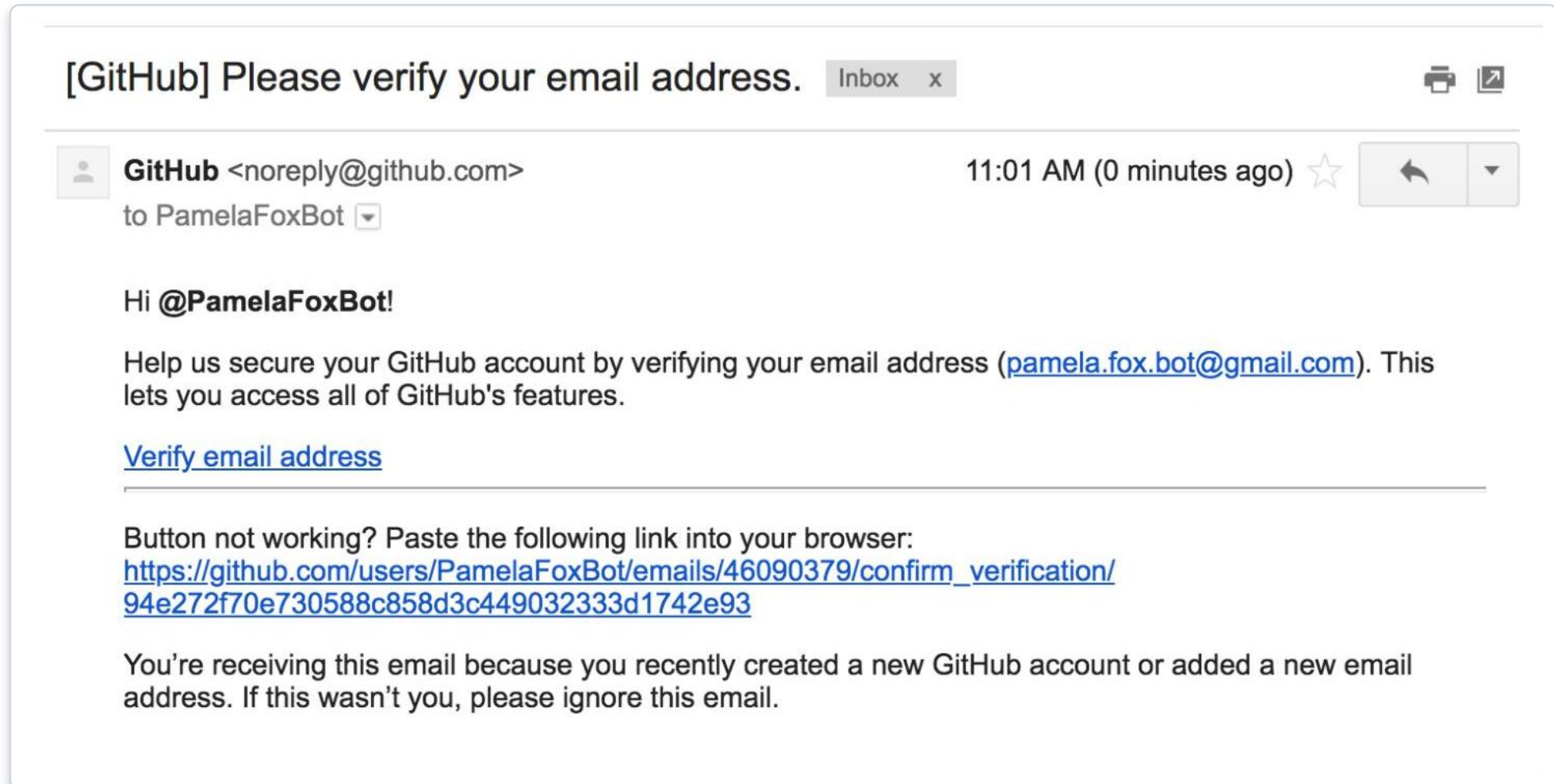
Submit skip this step

4

PART 1 · STEP 4

Verify your email address

Open your inbox and click the verification link GitHub sends you. *You must verify before you can create a project.*



PART 2

Create a project for your website

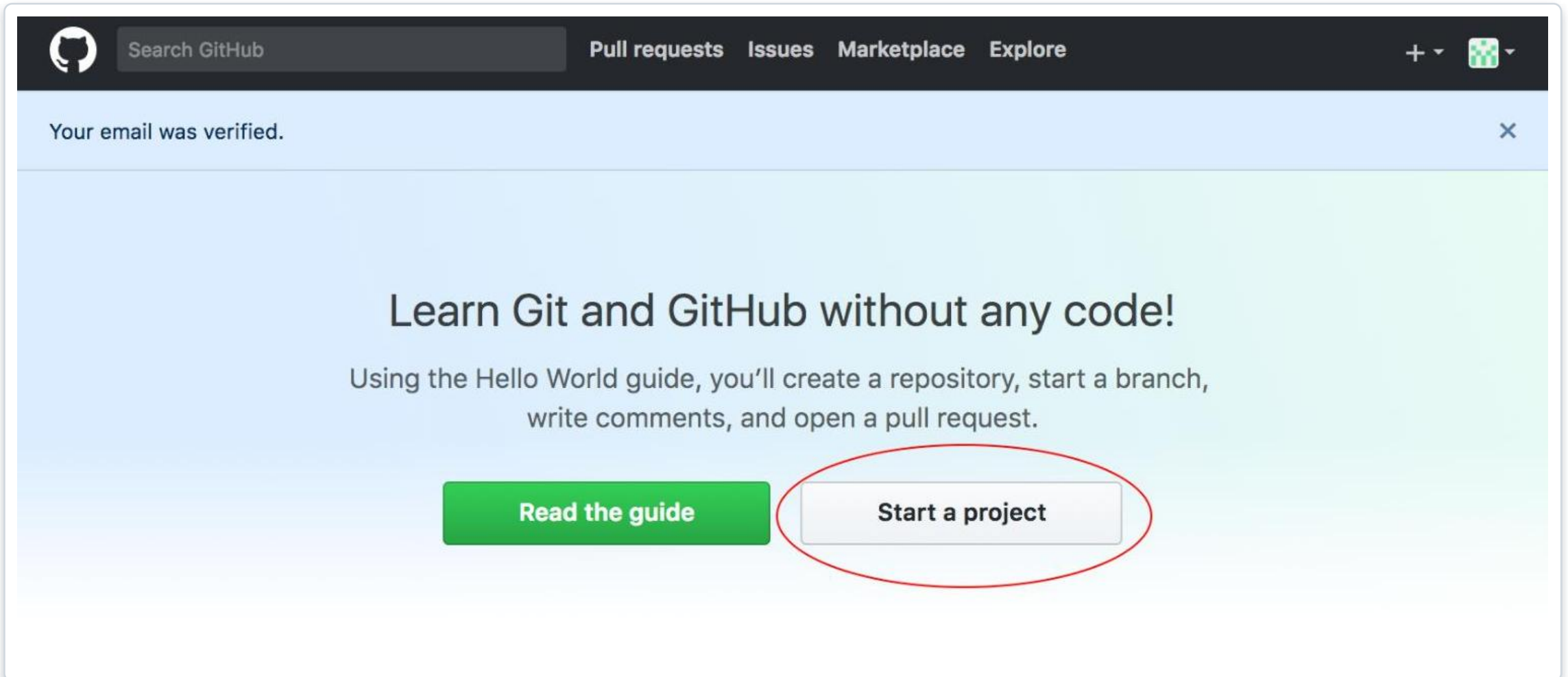
Turn a new repository into a published page — name it correctly, add your HTML, and commit.

5

PART 2 · STEP 5

Start a project

After verifying, the start page appears. Click “Start a project”.



6

PART 2 · STEP 6

Name it yourusername.github.io

Name the repository exactly YOUR_USERNAME.github.io. *That special name tells GitHub to publish the files to your public URL.*

Create a new repository

A repository contains all the files for your project, including the revision history.

Owner: PamelaFoxBot / Repository name: PamelaFoxBot.github.io ✓

Great repository names are short and memorable. Need inspiration? How about `verbose-potato`.

Description (optional): Project website

☒ Public
Anyone can see this repository. You choose who can commit.

☐ Private
You choose who can see and commit to this repository.

☒ Initialize this repository with a README
This will let you immediately clone the repository to your computer. Skip this step if you're importing an existing repository.

Add .gitignore: None Add a license: None ⓘ

Create repository

7

PART 2 · STEP 7

Create the first file

The new project has no files yet. Click the “README” link to create one quickly.

PamelaFoxBot / PamelaFoxBot.github.io

Watch 0 Star 0 Fork 0

Code Issues 0 Pull requests 0 Projects 0 Wiki Insights Settings

Quick setup — if you’ve done this kind of thing before

Set up in Desktop or HTTPS SSH `https://github.com/PamelaFoxBot/PamelaFoxBot.github.io.git`

We recommend every repository include a **README**, `LICENSE`, and `.gitignore`.

...or create a new repository on the command line

```
echo "# PamelaFoxBot.github.io" >> README.md
git init
git add README.md
git commit -m "first commit"
git remote add origin https://github.com/PamelaFoxBot/PamelaFoxBot.github.io.git
git push -u origin master
```

8

PART 2 · STEP 8

Rename the file to index.html

In the file editor, change the filename from README.md to index.html. *Servers expect index.html as the main file of a website folder.*

The screenshot shows the GitHub repository page for PamelaFoxBot/PamelaFoxBot.github.io. The repository name is at the top, followed by tabs for Pull requests, Issues, Marketplace, and Explore. Below the repository name are buttons for Watch (0), Star (0), and Fork (0). A secondary navigation bar contains links for Code, Issues (0), Pull requests (0), Projects (0), Wiki, Insights, and Settings. The main breadcrumb path is PamelaFoxBot.github.io / README.md, where 'README.md' is circled in red. Below the breadcrumb are tabs for 'Edit new file' and 'Preview'. The 'Edit new file' tab is active, showing a code editor with the following content:

```
1 # PamelaFoxBot.github.io
2 Project website
3
```

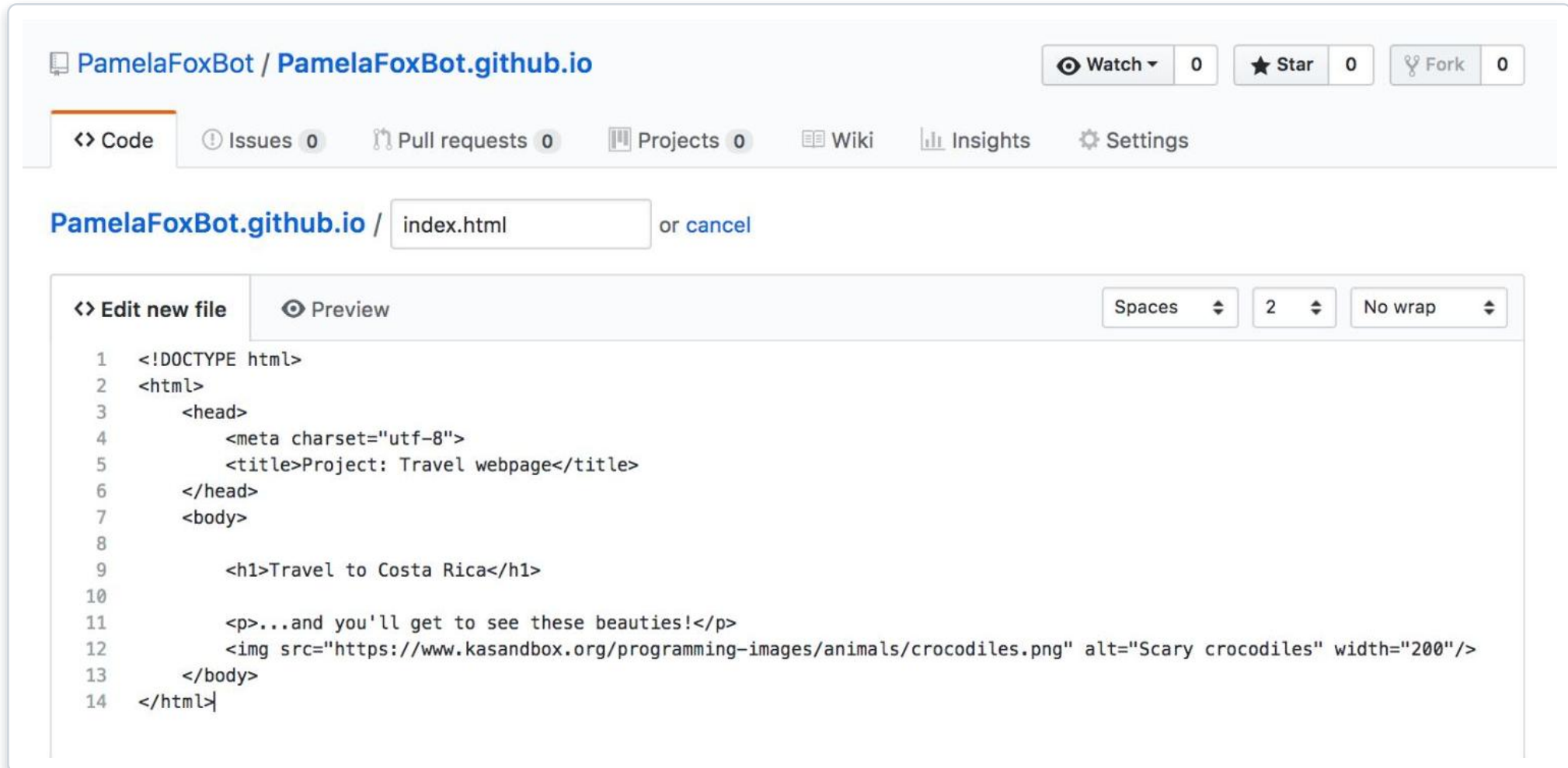
On the right side of the editor, there are settings for 'Spaces' (set to 2) and 'No wrap'.

9

PART 2 · STEP 9

Paste in your HTML

Delete the sample text and replace it with the HTML of your webpage. *You can copy it from a Khan Academy project or a file on your computer.*



The screenshot shows the GitHub web editor interface. At the top, the repository name is **PamelaFoxBot / PamelaFoxBot.github.io**. Below this, there are tabs for **Code**, **Issues**, **Pull requests**, **Projects**, **Wiki**, **Insights**, and **Settings**. The **Code** tab is selected. Below the tabs, the file path **PamelaFoxBot.github.io / index.html** is shown, followed by a text input field containing **index.html** and a button labeled **or cancel**. The editor area has two tabs: **Edit new file** and **Preview**. The **Edit new file** tab is active, showing the following HTML code:

```
1 <!DOCTYPE html>
2 <html>
3   <head>
4     <meta charset="utf-8">
5     <title>Project: Travel webpage</title>
6   </head>
7   <body>
8
9     <h1>Travel to Costa Rica</h1>
10
11     <p>...and you'll get to see these beauties!</p>
12     
13   </body>
14 </html>
```

On the right side of the editor, there are settings for **Spaces** (set to 2) and **No wrap**.

10

PART 2 · STEP 10

Commit the new file

Scroll to the Commit area and click “Commit new file”. *Each commit records a new version with a short message describing the change.*



Commit new file

Add an optional extended description...

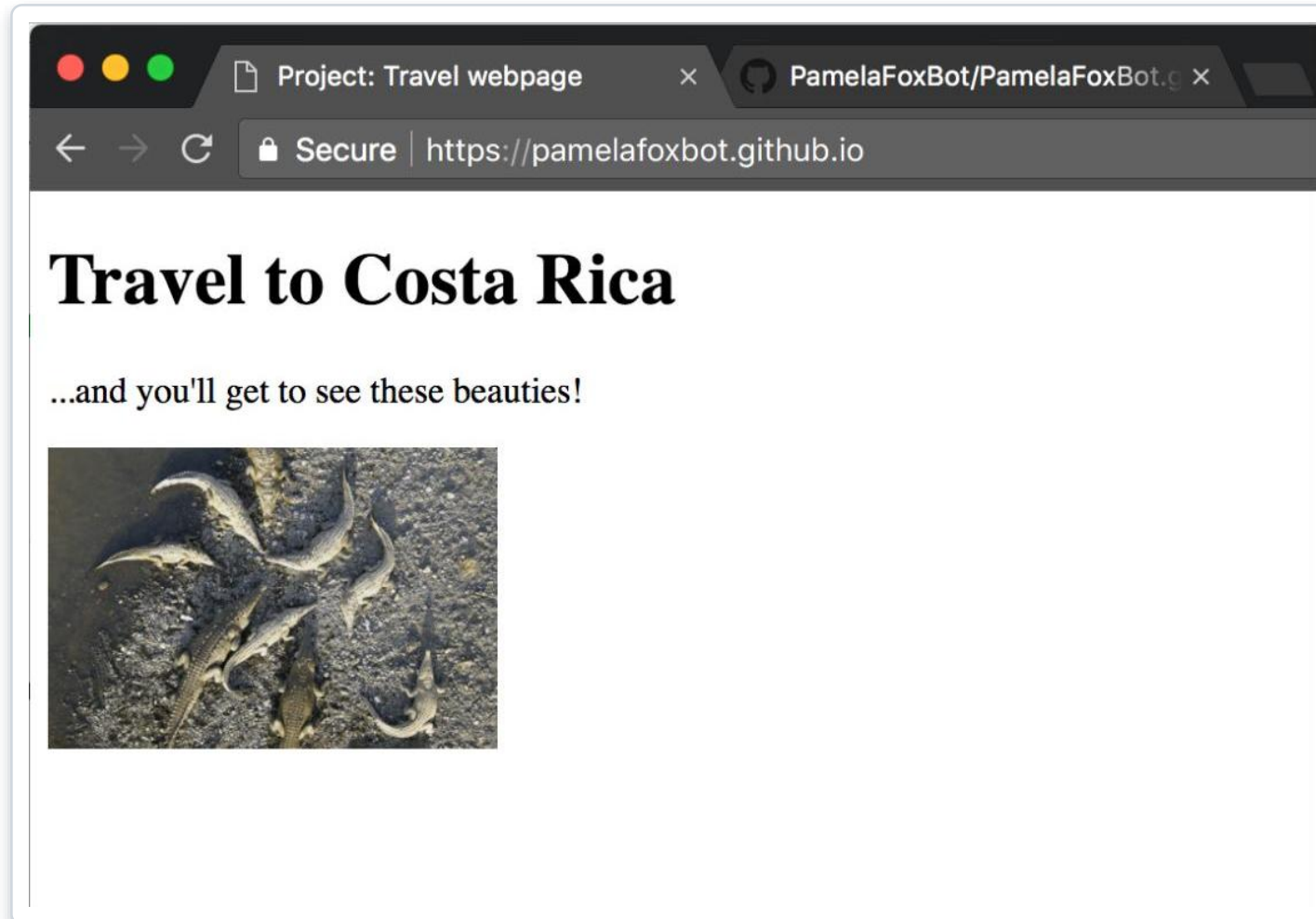
Commit new file Cancel

11

PART 2 · STEP 11

View your live site

Type `yourusername.github.io` in the browser and reload until the page appears. *Publishing takes 1–10 minutes; hard-reload (hold Shift) to clear the cache.*



PART 3

Upload a multi-file website

Already building a site with many files on your computer? Upload them all at once instead of copying each by hand.

12

PART 3 · STEP 12

Open the file uploader

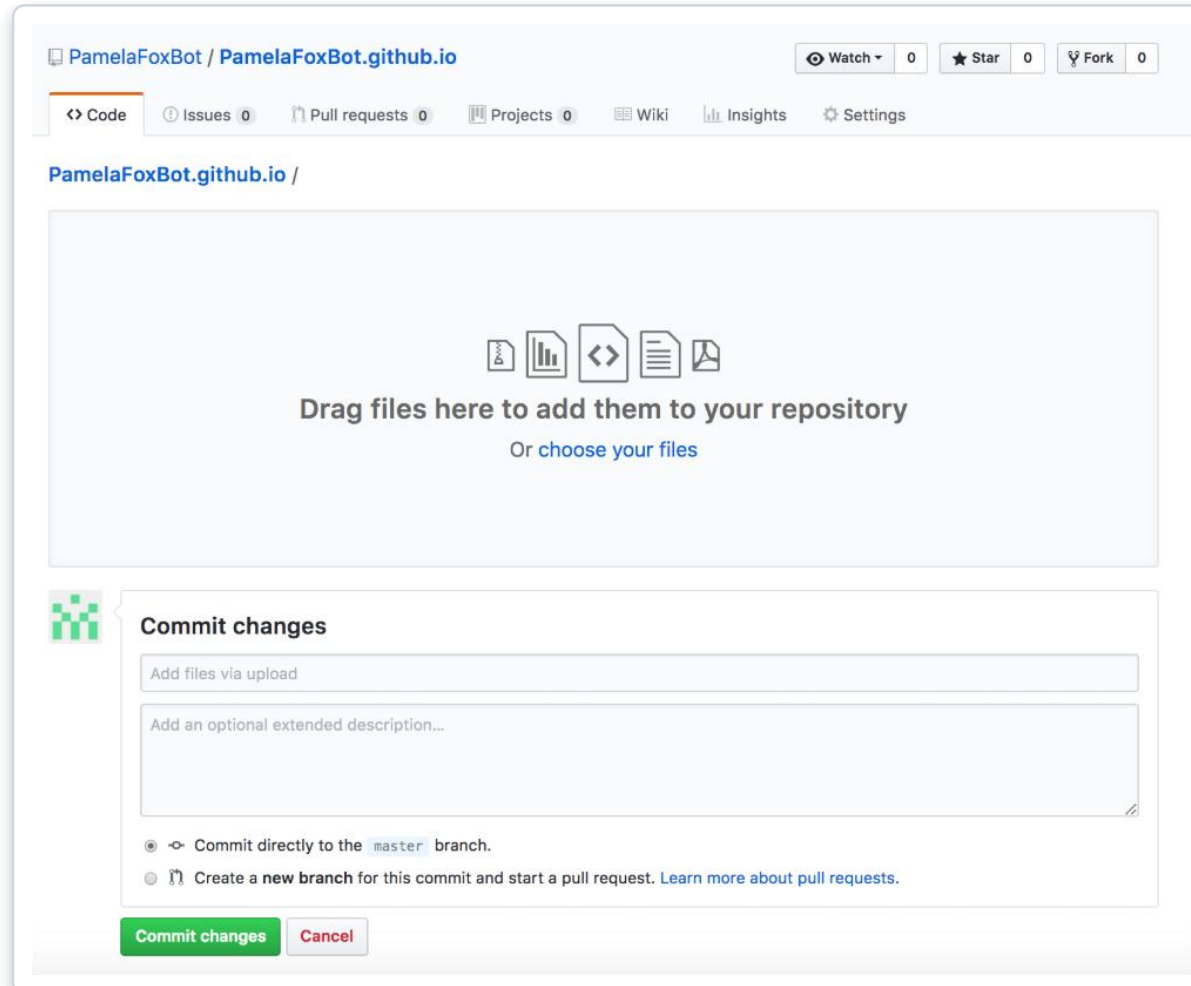
Open your project on GitHub and click “Upload files”. Use this for sites with several HTML, CSS, JS, and image files.

The screenshot shows the GitHub repository page for PamelaFoxBot/PamelaFoxBot.github.io. The browser address bar displays the URL: `https://github.com/PamelaFoxBot/PamelaFoxBot.github.io/tree/master`. The repository name is **PamelaFoxBot / PamelaFoxBot.github.io**. The page includes navigation links for Pull requests, Issues, Marketplace, and Explore. The repository statistics show 0 Watch, 0 Star, and 0 Fork. The main navigation bar includes Code, Issues (0), Pull requests (0), Projects (0), Wiki, Insights, and Settings. The Project website section shows 1 commit, 1 branch, 0 releases, and 1 contributor. The bottom section shows the latest commit by PamelaFoxBot, titled 'Create index.html', with the commit hash dbeb8c3 and the file index.html.

The 'Upload files' button is circled in red.

Drag and drop your files

The uploader appears. Drag-and-drop your files, or use the file chooser.

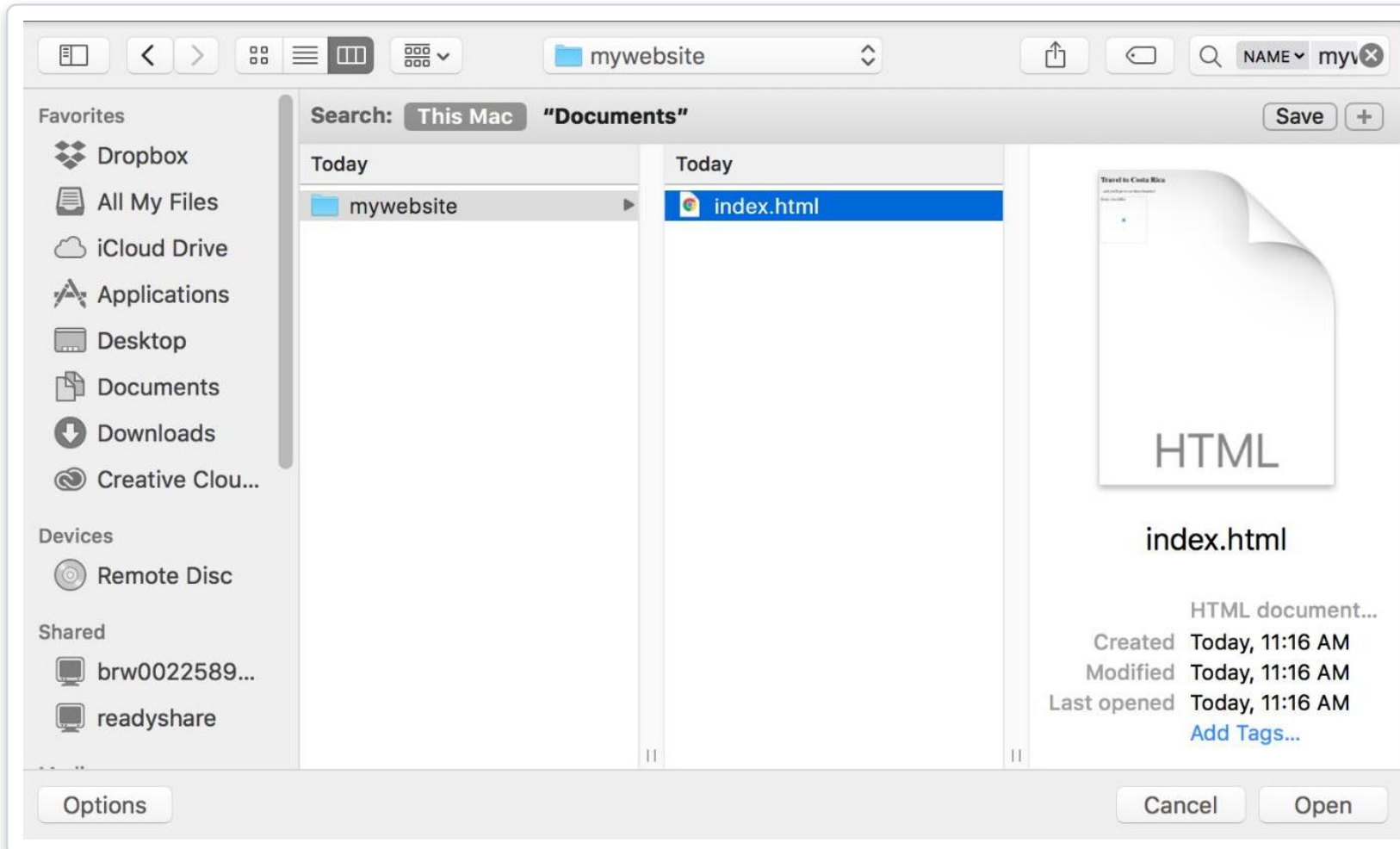


14

PART 3 · STEP 14

Choose your files

Find your project folder and select the files to upload. *If unsure, upload everything — GitHub only makes new versions of changed files.*



15

PART 3 · STEP 15

Commit your changes

Edit the commit message and click “Commit changes”, then reload your site. *Remember: changes take up to 10 minutes to go live.*

[PamelaFoxBot.github.io](#) /



Drag additional files here to add them to your repository

Or [choose your files](#)

index.html

×



Commit changes

Upload index.html instead

Add an optional extended description...

☒ Commit directly to the `master` branch.

☐ Create a new branch for this commit and start a pull request. [Learn more about pull requests.](#)

Commit changes

Cancel

BEST PRACTICE

Develop locally, publish when ready

Do your building and testing on your own computer, and upload to GitHub only once you are happy with how the site looks locally.

“

Patience is our friend here — changes take up to 10 minutes to go live. 😊

Your site is live at

`yourusername.github.io`

Build it, commit it, share it.

Source: Khan Academy — “Hosting your website on Github,” Intro to HTML/CSS: Making webpages. Screenshots © Khan Academy / GitHub, used for educational purposes.